INCREDIBLE INDIA

7 Mistakes First-Time Visitors Make in India

And How a Local Friend Saves You From All 7

Connect People. Discover India. Experience the World.

Free guide - Phase 1 preview

Independent community initiative. Not affiliated with the Government of India or the Ministry of Tourism.

The 7 mistakes

1. Paying tourist prices for everything

Without a local, the first price you hear is rarely the real price. Ask a local friend what a ride, a meal or a souvenir usually costs before you pay. If a price feels sudden or rushed, pause, smile and check first - a short walk away, the same thing is often far cheaper.

2. Trying to see too much, too fast

India rewards slow travel. Rushed itineraries burn people out. Pick two or three places per trip and leave empty afternoons in between. The best moments - a family meal, a festival lane, an unplanned walk - never fit a packed schedule.

3. Trusting the wrong helper at stations & sights

Unsolicited help often ends in a commission shop, not your destination. At stations and sights, go to the official counter or ask your local friend first. A genuine helper never rushes you and never asks you to follow them to a shop.

4. Eating only where tourists eat

The best food is usually two lanes away from the famous spot. Ask your host where their family eats. Eat where locals queue, drink bottled water, and try one new dish a day rather than everything at once.

5. Getting transport wrong

Wrong train class, wrong platform, wrong auto fare - small errors, big days lost. Confirm the platform and coach before you board, agree the auto fare before you sit down, and keep your route open on your phone so you can follow along.

6. Missing the real India between the monuments

Families, festivals, villages and home food never make it into package tours. Leave a day free for a village visit, a home meal or a local festival. That is the India you will remember longest.

7. Having no one to call when plans break

A local friend turns a problem into a phone call, not a crisis. Before you travel, save your host's number, your hotel address and the emergency numbers below. If a plan breaks, call your local friend first - do not try to fix it alone at midnight.

Packing & safety checklist

[ ] Documents

Passport, visa printout, travel insurance details, a photocopy of your passport kept separately.

[ ] Money

Some cash in rupees for small shops and autos, plus a card. Keep cash in two places, not one wallet.

[ ] Phone / SIM

A local SIM or eSIM, your host's number saved, hotel address saved offline, maps downloaded for your city.

[ ] Health

Any medicines you take, a small first-aid kit, hand sanitiser, and bottled water when you are unsure of the tap.

[ ] Day bag

Water, a snack, sunscreen, a light scarf or shawl, and a power bank for your phone.

[ ] Emergency numbers - save these now

Police 112 | Women's helpline 1091 | Tourist helpline 1800-11-1363. In any real emergency, contact local authorities first.

[ ] Before you leave

Share your itinerary with family, tell your host your arrival time, and agree your first meeting point in a public place.

Your next step - free

Book your free 20-minute India-Ready Call, and tell us your route for a free itinerary check. In the live version, the call is booked from the website - in this Phase 1 preview, no booking link is live yet.

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